



Green Valley Weekly News

Subject–Verb Agreement — Festival Edition

A2 English Class

Warm-Up: Look & Discuss



A Football Team

What do you think they are doing?



A Courtroom Jury

Are they all doing the same thing?



A Busy Market

Who do you see? What are they doing?



Read: Green Valley Weekly News



Green Valley Weekly News

Welcome to this week's Green Valley news! Our town is preparing for the Summer Festival.

First, the football story. [1] ***The team is practising every day this week.*** They want to win the big match on Saturday. But not everyone agrees on the plan! [2] ***The team are arguing about who should be the captain.*** Meanwhile, the singing competition needs a winner. [3] ***The jury is meeting today to choose the best singer.*** It is a difficult job because [4] ***the jury are still discussing the results — some judges like Amina, and some like Farid!***



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At the market, [5] *one-third of the fruit is already sold.* [6] *Two-thirds of the sellers are happy with their sales.* [7] *All of the food is fresh,* and [8] *all of the visitors are really excited.* [9] *Some of the water in the tank was too warm this morning,* but [10] *some of the new bottles are cold and ready.* Don't worry — [11] *no news is bad today!* In fact, [12] *no problems are expected before the festival opens.*

How far is the festival ground? [13] *Fifty kilometres is not too far for visitors from the city.* Many families are travelling. [14] *A good many visitors have already booked hotel rooms,* and [15] *many a family has visited Green Valley before.*



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Money is also good news. [16] *Five hundred dollars was collected for the Children's Charity last week.* [17] *Ten days is enough time to finish the last preparations.*

Do you know Mr. Khan? He is very busy this week. [18] *The teacher and coach is the same person this year* — Mr. Khan does both jobs! But at the market, [19] *the manager and the assistant are two different people*, so there are two people working there.



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Finally, everyone in town is included. [20] *The young are excited to dance at the festival,* and [21] *the elderly are proud to share old town stories.* [22] *The volunteers who are helping this year come from every part of Green Valley,* and [23] *the roads, which are newly repaired, will make travel easy for everyone.*

We hope to see you at the Green Valley Summer Festival this Saturday!



Check Your Understanding

1. What event is Green Valley preparing for?
2. What is the team arguing about?
3. Why is choosing a singing winner difficult?
4. Is the market doing well this year? How do you know?
5. Who is Mr. Khan, and why is he busy?
6. Name one group of people who are excited about the festival.



Answers

1. The Summer Festival.
2. Who should be team captain.
3. The judges disagree with each other.
4. Yes — most of the fruit is sold and most sellers are happy.
5. He is the teacher and the football coach — both jobs at once.
6. The young / the elderly / the visitors (any one).



Notice the Patterns

Noticing Chart

Look at the numbered sentences. Find the verb. Is it singular or plural? What do you notice?

Category	Sentences	What do you notice?
A. Collective nouns	[1] [2] [3] [4]	
B. Fractions	[5] [6]	
C. Quantifiers (all / some)	[7] [8] [9] [10]	
D. Quantifier (no)	[11] [12]	
E. Units / time / distance / money	[13] [16] [17]	
F. Many a / a good many	[14] [15]	
G. Article + noun	[18] [19]	
H. Adjective as noun	[20] [21]	
I. Relative pronouns	[22] [23]	



Build the Rule

Rule-Building Worksheet (1-5)

1. Collective nouns (team, jury...): group as ONE unit → verb is **SINGULAR**. Members as separate individuals → verb is **PLURAL**.
2. Fractions (one-third, two-thirds...): the verb agrees with the noun **AFTER** (before / after) "of."
3. Quantifiers — all / some: with uncountable nouns → verb is **SINGULAR**. With countable plural nouns → verb is **PLURAL**.
4. Quantifier — no: "no" + singular noun → verb is **SINGULAR**. "no" + plural noun → verb is **PLURAL**.
5. Units of measurement / time / distance / money: treated as ONE whole amount, so the verb is always **SINGULAR**.

Rule-Building Worksheet (6-9)

6. Many a / a good many: "many a" + singular noun → verb is **SINGULAR**. "a good many" + plural noun → verb is **PLURAL**.

7. Article + noun: "the X and Y" (one "the") = **SINGULAR** person/thing → verb is **SINGULAR**. "the X and the Y" (two "the"s) = **PLURAL** people/things → verb is **PLURAL**.

8. Adjective as noun (the poor, the rich...): this means "**ALL THE** people," so the verb is always **PLURAL**.

9. Relative pronouns (who, which): the verb agrees with **THE NOUN BEFORE** (who/which), not with "who/which" itself.



Rule Answer Key (1-5)

1. Unit → singular. Separate individuals → plural.
2. After "of" — the verb matches the noun that follows "of," not the fraction itself.
3. Uncountable → singular. Countable plural → plural.
4. Singular noun → singular verb. Plural noun → plural verb.
5. Always singular — the amount is one whole quantity, not separate items.



Rule Answer Key (6–9)

6. "Many a" + singular noun → singular verb (formal/literary). "A good many" + plural noun → plural verb.
7. One "the" = one person/thing → singular verb. Repeated "the" = two separate people/things → plural verb.
8. "The + adjective" means "[adjective] people" (plural) — the verb is always plural.
9. The antecedent (the noun the pronoun refers back to): singular antecedent → singular verb; plural antecedent → plural verb.



Practice

Exercise A: Choose the Correct Verb

Items 1–7

1. The committee ____ (is / are) meeting on Thursday to plan the schedule.
2. The committee ____ (is / are) unable to agree among themselves about the budget.
3. Half of the cake ____ (was / were) eaten before the party started.
4. Two-fifths of the workers ____ (was / were) absent yesterday.
5. All of the information ____ (is / are) correct.
6. All of the answers ____ (is / are) correct.
7. No homework ____ (is / are) better than too much homework.

Exercise A: Choose the Correct Verb

Items 8–14

8. No students ____ (was / were) late this morning.
9. Thirty dollars ____ (is / are) too expensive for this book.
10. The doctor and the writer ____ (is / are) both coming to the seminar.
11. The rich ____ (is / are) not always happy.
12. The man who ____ (live / lives) next door is a doctor.
13. Many a student ____ (has / have) failed this exam because of poor preparation.
14. A good many students ____ (has / have) passed with excellent grades.



Exercise A — Answer Key

1. is

2. are

3. was

4. were

5. is

6. are

7. is

8. were

9. is

10. are

11. are

12. lives

13. has

14. have

Exercise B: Find and Correct the Error

Each sentence has one mistake

1. The jury are considering the case carefully together as one team.
2. Three-quarters of the students is absent today.
3. All of the sugar are white.
4. No news are good news.
5. Fifty kilograms are too heavy for me to carry.
6. The poor is often forgotten by society.
7. The books, which is on the shelf, belong to me.
8. Many a soldiers have died in the war.



Exercise B — Answer Key

1. The jury **IS** considering the case... (acting as one unit)
2. ...students **ARE** absent today. (plural noun after "of")
3. All of the sugar **IS** white. (uncountable)
4. No news **IS** good news. (singular uncountable)
5. Fifty kilograms **IS** too heavy... (measurement = one amount)
6. The poor **ARE** often forgotten... (adjective as noun = always plural)
7. The books, which **ARE** on the shelf... (plural antecedent)
8. Many a soldier **HAS** died in the war. (many a + singular noun + singular verb)



Speak: Town Meeting

Town Meeting

Should Green Valley build a new sports park?

You are the Green Valley Town Committee. In your group, discuss the idea and decide: yes or no? Use your role card and try to use the target structures from today's lesson.

Your Role



Mayor

Try to say:

"All of the money is/are..."

"The committee is/are..."



Youth Rep.

Try to say:

"The young are excited about..."

"Many a young person has..."



Elderly Rep.

Try to say:

"The elderly are worried about..."

"No plan is perfect, but..."



Shop Owners

Try to say:

"Fifty thousand dollars is too much."

"Half of the shop owners are against it."



Team Captain

Try to say:

"The team is/are..."

"All of the players are..."



Structure Checklist

Tick each box when you use it in the meeting!

☐

Collective noun (team / committee)

☐

Quantifier (all / some / no)

☐

Money, distance, or time amount

☐

Many a / a good many

☐

The + adjective (the young / the elderly)

☐

Relative pronoun (who / which)



Quick Review: Is or Are?

The jury ____ arguing.

All of the water ____ clean.

No students ____ absent.

Fifty dollars ____ a lot of money.

The rich ____ not always happy.

Many a family ____ visited this town.



Homework: Write Your Own Weekly News!

Write a paragraph (60–100 words) about your family, school, or neighborhood — in the style of the Green Valley text. Use at least 6 of today's 8 grammar patterns, and check your work with the Structure Checklist!